
June
2026

ASMI^{nk}

Newsletter of the Archeological Society of Maryland, Inc.



2026 Tyler Bastian Field Session: Teague's Point

Stephanie Soder

MHT Research Archaeologist

The MHT archaeologists always say that the Field Session is simultaneously the hardest and most fun time of the year for us. We love getting out on site for 11 days and spending time with our volunteers, sharing our love of archaeology. This year was no different, though with what seemed to be many more obstacles than normal.

We typically see at least one day impacted by weather during the field session. But to have the very first day be rainy and cold? Brutal. We all persevered though, opening three units that first day - only to be met with dry, rock-solid dirt. The irony wasn't lost on us that the very rain that we hid from under tents would have made that concrete more manageable.



If that wasn't bad enough, having the second day cancelled due to storms really

tested our mettle. With rainy forecasts for the foreseeable future, I know I wasn't the only one concerned with how to get the ball rolling. Despite two more impacted days, our solid volunteer force led to a monumental amount of work being accomplished.



Over the course of the 11-day session, we opened the equivalent of 11 new excavation units and uncovered three excavation blocks from the 2025 session. Testing of Features 1, 3, and 4/8 were completed, which led to partial excavation of the brick-and-daub feature and surrounding area, testing of a potential cellar feature, and reaching the

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bottom of the shell-lined feature. Artifacts as large as the barrel hoops and as small as straight pins were recovered from all units, including the second half of an artifact recovered last year that continues to puzzle us.



While some of the artifacts were washed in the field lab, the remaining artifacts will be washed in the lab at Crownsville this

summer, followed by cataloguing of the entire collection. Volunteers interested in assisting with this work can reach out directly to Dr. Zac Singer at Zachary.singer@maryland.gov.

It's always a pleasure to work with our volunteers during the field session, and I know I speak on behalf of everyone at MHT that we truly appreciate all the effort that goes into this important work. Because of dedicated volunteers like you, we get to continue to contribute towards our understanding of past life in Maryland. Thank you to everyone who braved the elements, battled the concrete-dirt, and made some lasting memories!



Board Notes:

Pat Melville

Secretary, ASM

Why would anyone want to be Secretary of an organization? On the surface it looks like a thankless job. Believe it or not, it can be a vital task. Minutes are important because they provide a record of what happens when a board meets. But more importantly, the minutes present a historical record of the organization, such as ASM.

As a former archivist, historical information is important and vital to an organization. We secretaries play an essential role in providing this data.

Before I volunteered to place my name on the ballot as Secretary of ASM, I made sure that the Zoom meetings, essential for ASM with board members scattered throughout the state, were recorded. This makes the life of a secretary so much easier because the recordings are always available for consultation. In addition, the secretary can readily participate in the meeting without missing vital information.

I think I've answered the question at the beginning of this article. The history of an organization is important.

William B. Marye Award

John Fiveash

William B. Marye Award Committee

The William B. Marye Award is considered ASM's highest honor and is presented to an individual who has made long term contributions to the science of archeology in Maryland. Anyone can be nominated for the award and nominations are accepted from the general public.

Nominations can be submitted on-line as well as through e-mail or regular mail. Details are at the [William B. Marye Award](#) page on the ASM website. Any submission received by August 1st will be considered for the 2026 award.

Nominations are not held over from year to year, so if you know of a nominee who did not receive the award in the past, please submit a new nomination.

If you know of someone who has dedicated themselves towards the goals of this society then I urge you to nominate them for this award.

Please feel free to contact me if you have any questions about the award or the nomination process.

Upcoming Events:

ASM 2nd Qtr Board Meeting

June 13, 2026 - 9am - Virtual - all welcome

ASM Annual Meeting

October 10, 2026 - Josiah Henson Museum and Park, Bethesda, MD

[Paleoamerican Odyssey](#)

October 14-17, 2026, Santa Fe, New Mexico

[93rd Annual ESAF Meeting](#), November

11-15, 2026, Norwalk, Connecticut

Advanced Robotics Team (ART) Earns Motivate Award at 2026 FIRST Championship First LEGO League (FLL)

Team ART proudly represented Maryland at the 2026 FIRST Championship in Houston, Texas, held from April 29 to May 2, 2026. Competing alongside approximately 160 teams from around 90 countries and regions, Team ART demonstrated exceptional teamwork, creativity, and dedication on the global stage. In recognition of these efforts, Team ART was honored with the Motivate Award, one of the distinguished awards in the FLL program. This award celebrates teams that embrace the culture of FLL through strong team collaboration, outstanding team spirit, and enthusiasm. Receiving Motivate Award at the world level highlights Team ART's commitment to both technical excellence and outstanding team culture. This year's theme, UNEARTHED, challenged teams to explore archaeology and learn from the past to help shape the future. Team ART developed an automatic sifter powered by AI to detect artifacts in real time. Featuring a multi-language interface, the system is designed to assist archaeologists by improving efficiency and accuracy during excavations. Team ART's success would not have been possible without the generous support of our sponsors. Your encouragement and

contributions helped make this incredible experience possible. Congratulations to Team ART on this wonderful achievement!

You can check out the team's Automatic Sifter in action at the youtube link below:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sMfKcOZj3ik>

They have since made several improvements:

- A vibration motor for more power to help sift through the dirt on the mesh tray
- An arduino board to help control the motions of the vibration motor and the reciprocating motor
- The web app now automatically takes images and analyzes them at 5 second intervals, and the website is linked to the web app, ensuring that they start and end together

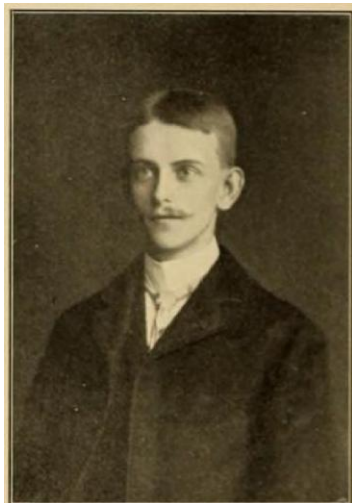


Team ART decorated home base during the 2026 FIRST Championship.

Maryland Archeology Past Portraits

Talbot Dickson Jones, Jr.

1880-1926



Talbot Dickson Jones, Jr. is a little known, but unsung, hero of Maryland archeology. Although sharing a surname with his more famous fictional counterpart, “Indiana Jones,” the similarities abruptly end there.

T. D. Jones was a meticulous late 19th and early 20th century amateur archeologist who focused his efforts on pre-Contact Native American sites on the Maryland Western Shore. Jones searched for artifacts primarily in the Patapsco drainage, but also visited the Patuxent, Severn, Gunpowder, Susquehanna, and even Anamessex drainages. Unlike most of his contemporaries, Jones took great care in recording when and where he collected Native American artifacts, marked his site locations on maps, and carefully catalogued his collection. He then took the next step and interpreted his finds in terms of prehistoric settlement patterns, relationship to the landscape, differences in tool types and materials found in different regions and on various kinds of sites, and trading patterns based on the geological sources of the stone artifacts. Though never published, Jones’ observations were ahead of his time and are still valuable sources of archeological information that can be applied to current research.

Based on his notes, Jones appears to have started collecting in earnest about 1890. As a young man, he attended Johns Hopkins University (JHU). He appears to have gained an appreciation of Maryland geology and geography during his tenure there, applying what he learned to locate and interpret sites and artifacts. In 1899, he graduated from Hopkins with a Bachelor of Arts degree emphasizing history and politics. His photograph shows a slight young man who reportedly weighed in at only 118 pounds, the smallest in his class. Later that year T. D. Jones found a spectacular cache of 109 rhyolite bifaces in western Anne Arundel County, a discovery made more exciting by the documentation of South Mountain rhyolite in Central Maryland just a few years earlier by noted JHU geologist George Huntington Williams. That same year Jones’ donated a number of artifacts to the Goucher Women’s College Museum.

From 1899 to 1901, Jones was teaching school in the St. Denis area and still collecting. He continued his fieldwork, wrote up notes, made maps and catalogues, and analyzed his collections at least through 1908. That year his father died unexpectedly, and the following year, he appears to have joined the Baltimore workforce in the insurance business. In 1911, he married Margaret Robertson Pue. The couple occupied a “country home” they called “Sunnyside” outside Ellicott

City on Old Columbia Pike, a setting perhaps made more attractive to T. D. Jones by its proximity to collecting areas on both the Patapsco and Patuxent drainages. The home is still there, and T. D. Jones would no doubt be pleased to know that the Italianate fieldstone structure is in the Maryland Inventory of Historic Properties (H-405), and is eligible for listing in the National Register of Historic Places. Jones continued in the insurance and real estate business in Baltimore through at least 1922.

Even when carefully documented, the fate of most private artifact collections is to be broken up, often sold, and to lose their associated information with the owner's death, making them useless for archeological studies. Fortunately, T. D. Jones himself had begun donating his records and collections to JHU by 1901. Jones died at a relatively young age on March 3, 1926 and was buried in Loudon Park Cemetery. Still more of Jones' archeological materials survived because his widow had the foresight to donate his remaining collection to Johns Hopkins University in 1927. Margaret Pue Jones joined her husband in 1959.

Not all early collections that were donated to educational and scientific institutions survived intact or can be relocated (visualize the fictional Indiana Jones and the final disposition of the Ark of the Covenant). Institutional collections are sometimes loaned and not returned. Some are divided for exhibits and separated from their documentation. Sometimes old collections whose significance is not understood are even discarded to make space. Some collections just linger in obscurity as the mission of institutions change. T. D. Jones' collection might have fallen to that fate. However, Jones' archeological records and over 2000 artifacts were rescued thanks to the efforts of Tyler Bastian, Maryland's first State Archeologist, who was hired by the Maryland Geological Survey in 1969 when the newly founded Division of Archeology was headquartered at JHU.

In 1970, JHU student Vance Tiede alerted Tyler Bastian to Jones' collection of Maryland archeological records and artifacts. Under Bastian's guidance, avocational archeologist Carroll Bennett began a major effort in 1980 to examine and re-catalogue the T. D. Jones' material. Bennett correlated many of Jones' localities and artifacts with formally recorded archeological sites in six Maryland counties. Jones' carefully documented notes and observations from the late 19th and early 20th centuries continue to provide invaluable data, particularly for areas that have since been destroyed by sand and gravel quarrying, development, and transportation corridors. Copies of T. D. Jones' notes and maps are now available to archeologists through the Maryland Historical Trust. His collections are located at the Jefferson Patterson Park and Museum.

T. D. Jones himself remains cloaked in obscurity, but his archeological accomplishments and legacy cannot be overstated. Given the choice between Indiana Jones' flash and T.D. Jones' dedication to preserving the past, I'll take the meticulous note-taking and thoughtful analysis of T. D. Jones any day.

Past Portraits is an ongoing project to document the stories of people who have contributed to archeology in Maryland. This series was first published in the [Eastern States Archaeological Federation](#) Journal, *Archaeology of Eastern North America*, in 2020 and highlights personalities that have contributed to archeology in Maryland over time. ASMIInk will publish excerpts from this series.

ASM Chapter News

Central Chapter:

Central Chapter meetings are by Zoom only. Katharine Fernstrom sends the link to the email group. Stay tuned for more details. For more information and to be added to the Zoom list contact [Katharine Fernstrom](#).

Charles County:

Meets in person September through April at the Community Room of the LaPlata Police Department in LaPlata, MD on the third Thursday of the month. Email ccasm2010@gmail.com for more information.

Eastern Shore:

Dates and events are on chapter's website ([ASM Eastern Shore](#)), Facebook page ([Eastern Shore Maryland Archaeology](#)) and Instagram (@esmdarch). For more information, email esarcheology@gmail.com or jmrkin2@washcooll.edu

Calendar is here: bit.ly/ASM-ES and events are open to members and nonmembers. To be added to our social media updates, email esarcheology@gmail.com.

All events are open to anyone who wants to attend!

Open lab at Washington College: Contact Julie Markin at jmarkin2@washcoll.edu.

Mid-Potomac:

The chapter meets the third Thursday of the month from September through June. In-person meetings begin at 7p.m. for the business meeting followed by a presentation at around 7:30. The chapter meets at the ADU Showroom, 8501 Grovemont Circle, Gaithersburg, MD 20877. Please contact Don Housley for directions, if necessary.

Pizza will be available before the in-person meeting starting at 6:30pm for \$6 per person. If virtual meetings are necessary, they will be via Zoom with the business meeting also starting at 7 p.m. and the presentation around 7:30. Contact Don Housley to RSVP for pizza by 12 noon on the day of the meeting and for virtual Zoom meeting codes.

For up-to-date information concerning meetings, please contact [Don Housley](#), 301-424-8526, check the [Mid-Potomac Chapter Website](#) or send an email to: asmmidpotomac@gmail.com.

Upcoming Events:

Thursday, June 18, 2026: Chapter picnic at a chapter member's house. Please contact Don Housley for more details.

Monocacy:

For information contact: monocacyarcheology@gmail.com (mailbox monitored intermittently) or call Jeremy Lazelle at 301-471-8433.

Northern Chesapeake:

A business meeting at 7pm and is followed by the presentation at 7:30. Locations vary. Contact Dan Coates at 410-808-2398 or dancoates@comcast.net

Western Maryland:

Programs are held the fourth Friday of the month, at 7:30 pm at the **History Discovery Center at Blue Spring at 400 N. Mechanic Street, Cumberland, MD**. Unless noted. Chapter email: wmdasm@yahoo.com

Meeting announcements are sent also to CTN; WFWM, and the Oakland Republican.

Contact Us

The **Archeological Society of Maryland Inc.** is a statewide nonprofit organization devoted to the study and conservation of Maryland archeology.



ASM members receive the monthly newsletter, ASM Ink, publication notice of the biannual journal, MARYLAND ARCHEOLOGY, reduced admission to ASM

events and a 10-percent discount on items sold by the Society.

Contact Membership Secretary Ethan Bean, ethan.bean@marylandarcheology.org, for membership rates.

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